CUSTOMER CONTINUITY

The Customer Already Told Sales

The first test of a handoff is what your project manager can do with it.



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At the showroom, the homeowner told your rep that the builder could receive flooring at the side entrance, but only before the drywall crew arrived. The rep wrote it in a note with the sample and finish. Three weeks later, your warehouse sees a delivery address and a date. The driver calls the owner for access. The owner calls the builder, who says the delivery was meant to come a day earlier. You have an accepted order and three people working out what it means.

The sale reached your warehouse. The commitment that made the delivery possible stayed at the showroom.

A sales handoff should carry the agreed work, the promises that affect delivery, the current version of supporting records, the open decisions, and the person responsible for the next action. Test it by asking the receiving team what it can safely do and what it would still need to ask the customer.

What can go wrong when the information arrived?

The receiving team can have the correct file and interpret it differently from the sender. Define what consequential fields mean, which version governs, and who can confirm a conflict. A successful transfer is one the next team can act on under the right assumptions.

When you order online for pickup at an Apple Store, there's a confirmation that Apple has the order and a separate notification telling you when to come in. You can designate someone else to pick up eligible items. Apple says the person collecting the order needs the order number, ID and the pickup code or Wallet pass. The store needs to know what it can hand over and to whom. The customer needs a signal that makes a trip worthwhile. One order has to carry those facts across the website, the store and whoever is going to collect it. Apple's shopping help on order status · Apple Pickup instructions

Ask what "confirmed" means in your own sales records. A rep may use it for the date the customer requested. The warehouse may read it as a date dispatch and the site have both accepted. If that difference affects a crew or vehicle, separate the two states. Put the applicable time and conditions in the record the dispatcher uses.

Which parts of the customer conversation need to travel?

Send what changes the receiver's next action. Include the customer's objective when it explains a promise, the accepted version of the order, site conditions that affect execution, and unresolved items with an owner. A link to the full conversation can help someone review history. The receiver

needs the decisive information where the work starts.

The receiver needs to know	Flooring handoff example
What is approved?	White oak, finish 04, accepted quote revision 3. The earlier showroom sample was finish 02.
What did the business promise?	Deliver before the drywall crew starts, subject to site and dispatch confirmation.
What is still open?	Side access and the actual receiving window.
Who acts next?	Dispatch confirms with the builder and records the window before releasing the truck.

If the quote says finish 04 and the order shows 02, the warehouse needs a visible hold and a person who can settle the conflict. A software integration that chooses whichever field was updated most recently can create an expensive decision nobody intended to make. Carry the governing record and let someone confirm it when the inputs disagree.

How much detail should cross the handoff?

Decide by what someone will do with it. The warehouse needs the product, quantity, release status and delivery requirements. The project manager may also need to know why the buyer insisted on that finish and which rooms can accept a substitute if supply changes. Give the warehouse a short operational view and the project manager access to the accepted order and the relevant conversation. Both should be able to trace the information to the same source.

The question is especially useful when a rep promises something outside the standard offer. If the homeowner arranged delivery at the side entrance for one phase only, a single permanent note against the account could carry the exception into the next job. Attach it to the delivery it governs and state when the team should check it again. The right place to record a detail depends on how long it stays true.

How do you test whether a handoff is complete?

Give a real, redacted order to the person who would receive it. Ask them to identify what's approved, what to do next, who must be involved, and what would stop them. Follow the order through the tools they actually use. The result is a practical test of the information and the handoff rule.

Use a **Customer Handoff Map**. For each piece of information, record its source, who needs it, and what action depends on it. Put a check at the point where the receiver can confirm readiness. For the delivery above, the showroom rep can pass the access requirement, dispatch can confirm the window with the builder, and the warehouse can release once it sees both. That division also gives the customer one clear answer when they ask who to call.

Try it on a straightforward job and one with a late change. Track repeat calls for information already given, releases held for good reason, and exceptions found after dispatch. A brief hold may be an improvement if it catches a wrong finish before the load leaves.

Three details worth testing at the next transfer.

- Check what the receiving person means by the status they see.
- Send the accepted version and the promises that affect the work.
- Ask the receiver to show how they would act on it.

The homeowner who told the showroom about the side entrance should hear from you when there is a delivery plan to confirm. The directions she already gave should be part of that conversation.

Frequently asked questions

Is connecting the CRM and order system enough?

Check which records and meanings actually cross. An integration can carry a customer name and still leave out an agreed condition. Test the resulting order with the receiving employee.

Should every tool store the whole conversation?

Keep a reliable record of the history and make it accessible to authorized people who need it. Pass the specific facts required for the next action to the tool where that action happens.

Who owns a handoff that crosses departments?

The sender owns sending a usable record. The receiver owns confirming they can act. Give one role authority to resolve or assign a conflict so it has a clear destination.

The flooring order is illustrative. The pickup example comes from Apple's published shopping instructions.